



Wake up to your music

Apple now allows you to select a song of your choice to wake you up. Read more: <http://dgit.in/applearm>



No more tripping

Secure the position of your camera tripod or lighting stand by using the suction pads. Read more: <http://dgit.in/sctnpads>

Brick and mortar

Another important reason is the paranoia we Indians have about our money being spent online. No matter how geeky and modern you think you are, you are always checking and double-checking anything that deals with online transactions. No matter how much we buy online, we're still not oblivious to the risks. Thus, we don't save our card details on even favourite sites. We choose the card with the lowest credit to use online, so in case of a hack the damage will be minimal.

We change our passwords often, and we have better passwords than most. Our banks make sure we do so too. We still opt for cash on delivery as much as possible, and the fact that it's an option on most e-commerce sites is testament to how popular it is. It's also safe. Because no confidential banking information is exchanged when opting for this. This is actually what's made e-commerce such a success in India. Free delivery and cash on delivery have been instrumental in popularising it. The discounts and crazy deals help too, obviously.

Attack Abroad

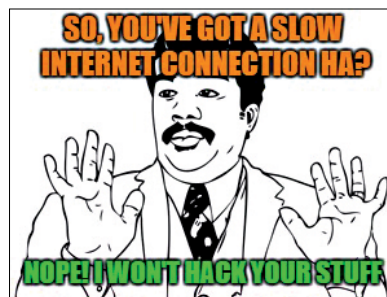
Most Indian hackers, who could perhaps find ways around all the complexities we've mentioned above would still prefer to hack people in better off countries because the rewards are just that much better. As a hacker, if you are able to hack a first-world citizen, you get Dollars, Pounds or Euros, which obviously are a much higher value given that the standard of living abroad is much higher. Thus more first-worlders have much more cash in their accounts and credit cards than the average Indian.

For example there are many examples of support frauds being run by Indian companies posing as official Microsoft support staff, and conning people into paying them money to fix non-existent problems. Microsoft even sued a few that were doing this, but many fly-by-night operators continue to do this. Most Indians would disconnect a call in fear if they suddenly received a phone call from "Microsoft support staff".

"Oh no! They're on to me, time to format!" (Shame on you if you have to ask why.)

Abroad however, where people actually pay for software, this would be a routine call from a software company. Heck, people might think because of Apple ruling the roost, Microsoft might be trying harder to offer some premium service. Also, people abroad are just used to paying over the phone in general. This makes them an easier target for a scam. Very few Indians would volunteer their card information to someone over the phone!

Finally, there's the question of jurisdiction. By the time the scam is discovered, if at all, the scamsters have changed their city of operation in India, and it's like looking for a needle in a haystack. The delay between a foreign agency talking to their government, then that government talking to ours, and then to the cops enables the scamsters to get away. If they targeted Indians, one whistleblower could set the cops after them a lot faster, as it's all a local matter.



An Apple a day

We don't use Apple. Well, some of us do. Most don't. Some don't like it, some don't care, and most can't afford it. We realise that we're going to get flak for this, especially because the Apple fanboys are the most vicious, but the "fappening" is proof that Apple gets stuff wrong, and spectacularly so.

It's not just iCloud that's vulnerable, but apparently there have been known hacks that remain unfixed for months on end. Search for "Apple XARA exploit" – here XARA stands for cross (X) app resource access, or basically an exploit that allows an app to access the data of another app (which could be your App Store, netbanking app, anything!). It's ironic to this writer that, as a thumb-rule, only the rich can afford Apple in India, and the only logical targets for hackers are rich people! You might as well wear a sign that says "Hack me, I'm rich and I have an iPhone!"

If you do have an iPhone, first, stop trying to recharge it in the microwave! Next, if you're worried about XARA, just delete all apps from any developer you don't know, and make sure you only install popular apps. Apple is still working on a fix since this was first reported in October 2014!

Use Linux

If you've been to an engineering college in India, you've probably experienced Linux. If you're reading this, you've probably experienced some Linux distro or the other that we've given away in our DVD. Many of you will still be using a distro, or running dual-boot with Windows.

We even know a few people who only do online transactions from within their Linux installs, or by running a live CD! Although a tad paranoid (even for us), it is a secure way of transacting that you can't argue with. A live CD especially is useful because it doesn't have any added on software, and if someone's been trying to attack your IP with Windows' exploits, suddenly coming on from Linux makes all that effort useless!

As we're used to Linux thanks to college, we'd urge more of you to switch to it. *Viva la Open Source!*

<insert some wise@\$\$ header here>

This article could theoretically be never ending, given our wonderful diversity as a country. There are so many customs and societal norms that pre-dispose us to being wary of a scam.

For one, our great leaders are always involved in scams, so much so that the word scam itself is now boring. We've been so bombarded with scams and so surrounded with corruption that suspicion is our default mental state. This is the polar opposite of most first world countries where there is more faith in the system, and conspiracy theorists are the exception. It just makes it harder for us to be scammed.

We're sure to have missed a few methods in which Indians are hacker-proof, so make sure to write in to editor@digit.in if you can think of any more. We'll share them in our readers letters section. Meanwhile, enjoy this Independence day knowing that we're more likely to be the hacker in India, and not so much the hackee... *Jai bind!*